Netflix Movies and Shows Dataset



Prepared by Prasanna Shetty

Date: 12-10-2026

PRASANNA SHETTY, 12-OCT-2026

NETFLIX DATASET (CONTENT TREND ANALYSIS)

1. What is the structure and scope of the titles.csv dataset?

A: The titles.csv dataset is a content catalog containing information about movies and TV shows. Based on the notebook, the dataset has 5,850 rows and 15 columns, and it includes fields such as id, title, type, description, release_year, age_certification, runtime, genres, production_countries, seasons, imdb_id, release_date, rating, rating_count, popularity, and score. The notebook also shows that when filtering for type == 'SHOW', there are 2,106 show records, meaning the dataset can be used to compare movies and series, analyze yearly release trends, study genre distribution, and examine audience ratings or popularity across different content types.

2. Why is the genres column transformed before analysis?

A: The genres column is stored as a text representation of a Python list, such as ['action'] or ['horror', 'comedy'], so it cannot be directly grouped or counted as individual genres. In the notebook, the column is processed using ast.literal_eval() and then exploded so that each title can have one row per genre. This transformation is important because many titles belong to multiple genres, and without separating them, analysis would treat combinations like ['action', 'comedy'] as a single category. Exploding the genres allows the report to identify the most common genres by year, rating group, title, or overall popularity, giving a clearer picture of the catalog's content mix.

3. What insights can age-certification analysis provide?

A: Age-certification analysis helps classify content according to suitable audience groups, such as family-friendly, teenage, or adult-oriented material. The dataset includes certifications like TV-Y, PG-13, R, and TV-MA, and the notebook specifically asks how many movies are present based on different age-certification levels. For example, some R-rated movies listed include titles such as *Taxi Driver*, *Deliverance*, *Life of Brian*, *Dirty Harry*, *Bonnie and Clyde*, *GoodFellas*, and *Full Metal Jacket*. This type of analysis is useful for platform reporting, content

recommendation, parental guidance features, and compliance checks because it shows how much of the catalog is intended for children, general audiences, or mature viewers.

4. How does credits.csv support the titles report?

A: The credits.csv file adds a talent layer to the catalog by linking people to titles through roles such as ACTOR or DIRECTOR. It contains fields like credit ID, title ID, person name, character name, and job type, which can be joined with titles.csv using the title ID. This allows the report to answer questions about cast size, leading actors, directors, voice actors, and recurring talent across movies or shows. For example, the file includes credits for titles such as tm84618, tm215638, and ts81331, showing actors or directors connected to specific productions. Credit data is especially valuable for recommendation systems, actor-focused reports, franchise analysis, and identifying titles with missing or incomplete metadata.

5. How can the OTT catalog data (titles.csv + credits.csv) be used for a content strategy / acquisition report?

A: The titles.csv file contains catalog-level streaming metadata — including id, title, type (Movie/Show), release_year, age_certification, runtime, genres, production_countries, seasons, and third-party quality/reach signals (imdb_score, imdb_votes, tmdb_score, tmdb_popularity) — while credits.csv adds the talent layer that links people to titles through roles such as ACTOR and DIRECTOR (with character populated for cast and null for directors, a structural rather than missing value). Together this structure makes the data suitable for a content-acquisition report that analyzes genre mix over time, quality by region, format suitability, content duration trends, and bankable talent — the kind of "what to greenlight next" view a strategy team actually runs. For example, the data can be aggregated to find the most frequent genres per release year (after exploding the multi-genre lists so co-tagged titles aren't miscounted), to compute median IMDb score by lead production country with a volume floor so tiny catalogs don't fake a ranking, to compare the rating distribution of movies versus shows (revealing that prestige quality clusters in series while the film slate carries a low-score tail), and

to surface mis-priced inventory via a popularity-versus-rating scatter that separates high-rated "sleepers" (e.g. *Numberblocks*, *Disclosure*, *The Toys That Made Us*) from heavily-promoted "hyped flops" (e.g. *Collision* at popularity 1194 but score 3.9, *Through My Window*, *The Privilege*). The certification field further supports a suitability lens, though it must be read carefully because label coverage is asymmetric (roughly **37%** of films carry a maturity label versus **~88%** of shows), making the apparent "adult skew" of the film slate partly a cataloguing artifact rather than a pure content fact; and the credits join enables a director-consistency shortlist (prolific, reliably high-scoring creators) that feeds exclusive-deal recommendations. Some titles show high platform popularity alongside low audience ratings, which suggests the report should also include a promotion-versus-reception misalignment analysis, a sleeper-visibility (re-marketing) opportunity list, and a format-aware budget split — with the explicit caveat, central to the memo's scope guardrail, that IMDb/TMDB figures are external metadata proxies and not internal viewing, completion, retention, or ROI data, so every greenlight hypothesis must be validated against the platform's own engagement telemetry before commitment.